Follow the Trail

From the Kaziranga wilds to Melbourne's cosmopolitan charms, actress **Neha Dhupia** shares her favourite journeys

Favourite destinations in India?

I love the Northeast. It's very raw and has so much to offer. I did a show called *MTV Roadies* which took me all over—Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal... I really loved Kaziranga and Ziro. My father was in the Navy and I was born and raised in Kerala, so I keep going back there. I also love Rajasthan. It's very cultural—and the heat doesn't bother me!

You visited Melbourne for the Boxing Day Test. What were the top highlights for you?

The MCG for sure. I did a tour where I walked around the boundary wall. The Puffing Billy Railway was a great family attraction. The Ballarat Wildlife Park was absolutely fantastic. Rayners Orchard in the Yarra Valley.... Also the little stuff, like the AC/DC lane, named for the iconic band.

What is Melbourne like as a city?

It's cosmopolitan, cultural, deep-rooted and knows where it belongs. At the same time, it's very global. Everyone is there for the same stuff. If there's a cricket match, they're all going to the stadium. As a city, I feel it has many stories to tell.

Is it challenging travelling with children?

Well, my children—three and six currently—are really good travellers. When I plan my itinerary, I like to do as many things I can with them. It's challenging sometimes, but it's also fun.

Three things you can't travel without?

In my case, it's three different types of bags. So, my fanny pack—I want to be hands-free with my children, right? But I need more space, so there's a handbag as well. Then there's a high chance I will go and shop my heart out—for that I have a folding flexi-bag.

—with Amit Dixit